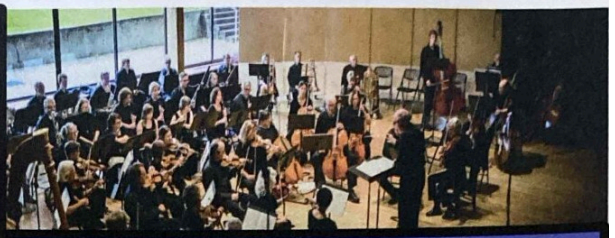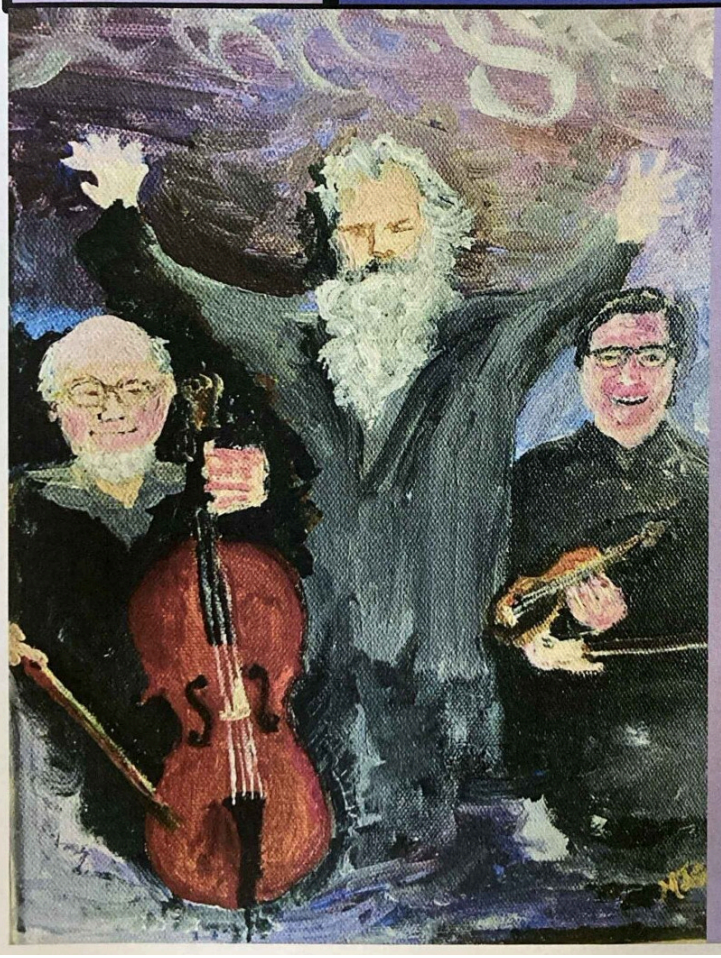
Sage City Symphony
Making Music Since 1973



Michael Finckel, Music Director



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Sunday,
May 17, 2026
4:00 PM
Greenwall
Auditorium
Bennington
College

The Sage City Symphony

Gerald Lanoue and Diane Bargiel, conducting

May 20, 2026 Greenwall Auditorium

Concerto for Violin and Cello in A minor, Op. 102 ("Double Concerto") ..... Johannes Brahms (1833-1897)

Michael Emery, Violin
Michael Finckel, Cello
Diane Bargiel, Guest Conductor

I. Allegro
II. Andante
III. Vivace non troppo

Vieille prière bouddhique: Prière quotidienne pour tout l'Univers ..... Lili Boulanger (1893-1918)

(An Old Buddhist Prayer: Daily Prayer for the Universe) for chorus and orchestra
Chorus members from:
Battenkill Chorale, Gene Marie Callahan, Music Director
Bennington County Choral Society, Ben April, Music Director
Burr and Burton Academy, Julie Freebern, Vocal Ensemble Director
Northern Berkshire Chorale, Anna Lenti, Music Director
Bennington College Voice Studios
First Congregational Church of Manchester, Linda Hueckel,

Music Director
United Church of Dorset and East Rupert, Tom Salmon, Music Director
The Sage City Symphony expresses its deep gratitude to our wonderful choral neighbors for finding the time and the energy to collaborate with us.
Diane Bargiel, Guest Conductor

Symphonic Metamorphosis on Themes of Carl Maria von Weber ..... Paul Hindemith (1895-1963)

Gerald Lanoue, Conductor

I. Allegro
II. Turandot, Scherzo
III. Andantino
IV. Marsch

Diane Bargiel, Conductor

Diane Bargiel received her Bachelor of Music degree in clarinet from the Dana School of Music, a Master of Music in clarinet from Michigan State University, Certification in Music Education from Carnegie Mellon University, and a certificate in Arts Administration from New York University. Diane also concentrated on conducting in graduate conducting seminars with Eugene Corporon, lessons with William Wiedrich, seven workshops with Larry Rachleff and Robert Cameron, and additional workshops with Allan McMurray, Elizabeth Green, Frank Battisti and others. In

2021, she retired from SUNY Adirondack as the last Humanities division chair and Associate Professor of Music. In 2015, Prof. Bargiel received the SUNY Chancellor's Award for Excellence in Scholarship and Creative Activities and in 1995 while at Susquehanna University, was presented the Dean's Award for Excellence in Teaching. Diane has been the principal clarinetist of the Sage City since 2012. Ms. Bargiel currently serves on the board of New England Arts Presenters as the chair of its Engagement committee, and is an adjunct at Burr and Burton Academy in Manchester, Vermont. Other professional highlights include having been president of the New York Association of College Music Programs, president of Pennsylvania Presenters, a board member of Arts Presenters of Northern New England, the Pennsylvania state chair of the College Band Director's National Association, a member of the first Creative Communities Council of Windham County (VT), a planning committee member for the first Performing Arts Exchange that covered the entire East Coast, and was also a conductor and panelist at the 2000 CBDNA Eastern Regional Conference at Yale University, among numerous other roles and volunteer involvement.

Gerald Lanoue, Conductor

Gerald Lanoue D.M.A., a Bennington Vermont native, is an active conductor and bassoonist in the Upstate New York and Southern Vermont area. Dr. Lanoue is privileged to be the music director for the Music Company Orchestra and is currently the principal bassoonist with the Sage City Symphony. He received an undergraduate education at the Crane School of Music in Potsdam New York and a masters

and doctorate at the University of Southern California. He studied conducting with Douglas Lowry, past Dean and conductor at the Eastman School of Music, as well as John Barnett, the associate conductor of the Los Angeles Philharmonic. Dr. Lanoue has served on the faculties of Riverside Community College and Santa Monica College. While in California he was an active orchestral and chamber musician serving as Principal Bassoon for the Bakersfield Symphony, Los Angeles Classical Ballet, Redlands Symphony, and the American Youth Symphony. He has performed most notably with Daniel Lewis, Yehuda Gilad, Jerry Goldsmith, Michael Kamien and Zubin Mehta.



Michael Emery, Concert Master and Violin Soloist

Michael Emery has blended performance with teaching to create an active musical career. He has collaborated in chamber music with many international artists, including Ruggiero Ricci, Elizabeth Pitcairn, André-Michel Schub, and Emanuel Ax, and has performed in the Sibelius, Ludwig Spohr and Paganini International Violin Competitions. He is concertmaster and frequent soloist with orchestras in New York and California, and has performed as soloist and concertmaster in Asia, as well as several major European cities. Mr. Emery has performed in collaboration with many contemporary composers, including Gunther Schuller, Jennifer Higdon, Joan Tower, Ezra Laderman, Lowell Liebermann, Tommie Haglund, Richard Danielpour, and John Corigliano. Mr. Emery earned his MM in Performance from the Manhattan School of Music as a scholarship student with

Erick Friedman and Raphael Bronstein, and served as concertmaster of the Manhattan Symphony. Michael is currently the concertmaster of the Sage City Symphony.



Michael Finckel, Cello Soloist

Michael Finckel enjoys a wide-ranging career as cellist, conductor, teacher and composer. A founding member of the Trio of the Americas and the Cabrini Quartet, he performs as soloist and chamber musician throughout the U.S. and with members of his family in the renowned Finckel Cello Quartet. His interest in contemporary music has involved him in performances with New York's leading new music ensembles including Speculum Musicae, Ensemble Sospeso, Columbia Symphonietta, the Group for Contemporary Music, Steve Reich and Musicians, and the American Composers Orchestra, as well as performances with members of the New York Philharmonic, under the direction of Pierre Boulez and Leonard Bernstein. Mr. Finckel has been Music Director of the Sage City Symphony in Vermont since 1982, and oversees the orchestra's extensive commissioning program. He is a member of the Hoff-Barthelson faculty, and is a regular summer faculty member of the Chamber Music Conference and Composer's Forum of the East (Vermont), and the Composers Conference and Chamber Music Center at Wellesley College in Massachusetts.

About our Music Director: Michael Finckel

Having served as principal cellist during Sage City Symphony's early years in the 1970s, and later as a commissioned composer and cello soloist, Music Director Michael Finckel continues the unique traditions and musical standards of the orchestra's founder, Louis Calabro.

A native of Bennington, Vermont, Michael's formative studies were with his parents, both prominent musicians well known throughout the state. He later attended Oberlin College Conservatory of Music and Bennington College, where he studied composition, conducting, and orchestration with Louis Calabro and Henry Brant. He has taught cello and composition at Bennington and Marymount Colleges, and at Princeton and Cornell Universities. As a member of the faculty of the Vermont Governor's Institute on the Arts, he taught gifted junior and senior high school students from around the state.

Currently living in New York City, Michael is engaged in an active multi-faceted career as soloist, chamber musician, composer, teacher, and conductor. As a cellist, he has performed with orchestral and chamber ensembles in venues from coast to coast and across Europe. His interest in contemporary music has involved him in regular collaborations with some of New York's leading new music ensembles and performances under the direction of Leonard Bernstein and Pierre Boulez.

The Board of the Sage City Symphony

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Program Notes

Concerto for Violin and Cello in A minor, Op. 102 ("Double Concerto")

Johannes Brahms (1833-1897)

Brahms' Double Concerto was his final work for orchestra, completed in the summer of 1887. Unusual in form, it features not one soloist but two—the violin and cello—engaged in intimate partnership, often exchanging lyrical phrases or blending into a single voice. The work was composed as a gesture of reconciliation toward his old friend, violinist Joseph Joachim, after a personal rift had separated them. By writing a concerto that Joachim could share with the cellist Robert Hausmann, Brahms offered not only a musical gift but also a personal olive branch.

The concerto opens with an arresting orchestral statement, followed by the cello's noble recitative-like entrance. The violin soon joins, and the two soloists launch into a dramatic

dialogue. Throughout the first movement (Allegro), one hears Brahms' mature style—weighty, intricate, yet full of warmth.

The slow movement (Andante) offers the heart of the concerto: a broad, songful duet between violin and cello that floats gently above the orchestra. Here Brahms achieves a chamber-like intimacy, as if inviting the audience to overhear a private musical conversation.

The finale (Vivace non troppo) is spirited and genial, infused with Hungarian dance rhythms that recall the composer's lifelong love of folk-inspired music. After moments of brilliance and play, the concerto closes with warmth rather than thunder, a fitting farewell to Brahms' orchestral voice.

https://independence-sinfonia.org/concert-1-program-notes-brahms-double-concerto.pdf

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Vieille prière bouddhique: Prière quotidienne pour tout l'Univers

Lili Boulanger (1893-1918)

The French composer Lili Boulanger. . . ranks alongside her sister, the conductor and teacher Nadia Boulanger, among the most significant female figures in the history of music." (Konstantin Galluhn, 2010/Translation: Bradford Robinson).

While studying in Rome in 1914 at the age of 21, Lili Boulanger began working on setting this excerpt from an ancient Buddhist text, which emphasizes loving kindness toward all creatures. When World War I broke out, she

returned to France to help with war-time needs, alongside her sister, Nadia, and the work's completion was delayed until 1917 and premiered in 1921.

Boulanger breaks up the text into four stanzas, each followed by the refrain, "without enemies, without obstacles, overcoming pain and attaining happiness, be able to move freely, each one in the path destined for them."

Text and Translation

	French translation by Suzanne Karpelès	English Translation
I:	Que toute chose qui respire	Let everything that breathes
II:	-- que toutes les créatures et partout	-- let all creatures everywhere,
	Tous les esprits et tous ceux qui sont nés	all the spirits and all those who are born,
III:	Que toutes les femmes, que tous les hommes	all the women, all the men,
	Les Aryens, et les non-Aryens	Aryans and non-Aryans,
	Tous les dieux et tous les humains	all the gods and all the people,
	Et ceux qui sont déchus	and those who have fallen,
IV:	En orient et en Occident, au Nord et au Sud	in the East and in the West, in the North and the South,
	Que tous les êtres qui existent --	Let all beings which exist --

French translation by Suzanne Karpelès	English Translation
Sans ennemis, sans obstacles, surmontant la douleur	without enemies, without obstacles, overcoming pain
Et atteignant le bonheur, puisse se mouvoir librement	and attaining happiness, be able to move freely,
Chacun dans la voie qui lui est destinée	each one in the path destined for them.

* “ ‘Abode of the Aryans’ is a name for Northern India in classical Sanskrit literature. The Manu Smriti (2.22) gives the name to ‘the tract between the Himalaya and the Vindhya ranges, from the eastern to the western sea.’” (Tibetan Buddhist Encyclopedia)

Both the early Church of Rome and the Buddhist tradition are called to mind by the chant-like style of the thematic construction. This is supported by the use of modal scales, with particular emphasis on the Phrygian mode. The choices made within the French Impressionistic color palette for the orchestra include the ethereal nature of two harps and celeste, a flute solo reminiscent of Debussy’s Prelude to the Afternoon of a Faun (1894), and the darker resonances of the English horn, bass clarinet, sarrusophone (played here using a contra-bassoon), along with four trombones and tuba. The lushness of the orchestral writing paired with the voices, sometimes singing angelically in repeated melodic intervals without words, work hand-in-hand to create a very emotional musical experience that enhances the spiritual nature and meaning of the text itself.

Diane Bargiel

Symphonic Metamorphosis on Themes of Carl Maria von Weber

Paul Hindemith (1895-1963)

Symphonic Metamorphosis on Themes of Carl Maria von Weber began life in early 1940, when Hindemith first took up residence in the United States after several years of public and private jousting with the Nazi government of his native Germany. The Nazis officially decried his music as "degenerate," though they may also have been responding to his private, but hardly secret, expressions of revulsion regarding their policies.

Hindemith sketched a series of movements based on themes by Weber, to be used in a ballet for a dance company run by Léonide Massine, who had already collaborated with Hindemith on the ballet Nobilissima visione. The project died when Hindemith and Massine suffered one too many artistic differences, provoking Hindemith to reconstruct the music into the Symphonic Metamorphosis on Themes of Carl Maria von Weber. The process produced a splashy, colorful orchestral piece of the kind that American audiences in particular seemed to like. The new piece was an immediate success when it was premiered by Artur Rodzinski and the New York Philharmonic in January 1944. Symphonic Metamorphosis on Themes of Carl Maria von Weber has remained perhaps Hindemith's most popular work.

The themes Hindemith used are from some of Weber's most obscure works, and came to Hindemith's attention because they could all be found in one volume of piano duets that he owned. Hindemith not only retained all but one of the themes almost exactly as Weber wrote them but also preserved much of the formal structure of the pieces as well, so that it is possible to follow the general outlines of Hindemith's score while listening to Weber's music, or vice versa, and have a pretty good idea of what's going on. Hindemith alters nearly everything else, making radical changes to the harmony and adding to the music both vertically (with different harmonies and new countermelodies) and horizontally (extending phrases or entire sections).

Symphonic Metamorphosis showcases Hindemith's unique compositional language with its virtuosic woodwind runs, inventive contrapuntal schemes, and prevalent use of perfect fourths. The work begins with a machine-like ostinato, which precedes the introduction of the main theme in the upper woodwinds. Much of the first movement alternates between triumphant brass fanfares and contrapuntal writing for small groups of woodwind instruments, culminating with a bright and climactic A Major chord.

The second movement is based on themes introduced by the flute, clarinet, and piccolo in its opening call and response. After a brief percussion episode, the main theme passes between sections in seven complete statements. The composer's contrapuntal artistry is put on full display as a second theme is introduced and developed into two fugues — the first ferociously scored for brass, the second a toccata

for woodwinds. A second percussion episode leads to an abbreviated recapitulation in which the original theme is presented in a truncated form, again, seven times before resolving with in a serene F Major chord.

Movement three begins with song-like woodwind solos accompanied by colorful, occasionally bird-like, ensemble interjections. The music intensifies through the addition of new instruments and denser harmonies leading to a reintroduction of the opening material enhanced by a virtuosic flute obbligato.

The “March” begins with trumpets and trombones playing a four-note declamatory fanfare based upon the interval of a perfect fourth. Hindemith develops the opening motive into the main theme of the movement, heard first in the woodwinds. In the trio, the horns introduce a second, more heroic theme. The two themes alternate throughout the movement, and the four-note fanfare returns to bring the work to a thrilling conclusion.

Northshore Concert Band
https://www.windrep.org/Symphonic_Metamorphosis_on_Themes_of_Carl_Maria_von_Weber

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Sage City Symphony

Piccolo

Nico Rainford

Flute

Wren Greystone *Principal*
Haven Lockhart (BC)

Oboe

Gale Rainford *Principal*
Rowan Ellsworth

English Horn

Jules Tanager

Clarinet

Diane Bargiel *Principal*
Bellamy Quimby *Principal*+*
Kai Silverton

Bass Clarinet

Casey Hawthorne

Bassoon

Gerald Lanoue *Principal*
Remy Upton *Principal**
Oakley Underhill

Contrabassoon

Gale Ravenscroft

French horn

Wren Marwood *Principal*
Corey Silverton (BC)
Gray Galloway
Peyton Oakhurst

Trumpet

Harper Ashdown *Principal*
Tatum Larkspur *Principal**
Nico Dalloway

Trombone

Riley Northcott *Principal*
Reese Calloway
Shawn Lindqvist

Bass Trombone

Marley Radcliffe

Tuba

Shawn Northcott

Timpani

Hollis Calloway *Principal*

Percussion

Jordan Hawthorne *Principal*
Shiloh Underhill (BC)
Quinn Glenhaven (BC)
Gale Silverton

Harp

Gray Dunmore *Principal*
Jody Wilmot

Celeste

Frankie Galloway

Violin I

Michael Emery
Concertmaster
Adair Yardley
Concertmaster *
Kai Larkspur
Asst. Concertmaster
Gray Ashcombe
Kai Fernley
Indigo Galloway
Toby Glenhaven
Riley Radcliffe

Violin II

Riley Greystone *Principal*
Micah Kingsley (BC)
Finley Dunmore
Blair Fenwick
Gale Holloway
Peyton Marwood
Corey Merriweather
Harper Oakhurst
Remy Rainford
Emerson Tanager
Robin Whitcombe

Viola

Lane Ellsworth *Principal*
Blair Hawthorne
Frankie Juniper
Shawn Lindqvist
Jordan Pemberton
Taylor Quimby
Morgan Wilmot

Cello

Ari Calloway *Principal*
Bellamy Brightwater
Iris Edgerton
Tatum Lockhart
Wren Stillwater
Shawn Vandermeer

Double Bass

Vale Larkspur
Kai Vandermeer
Skyler Fernley *Principal (BC)*

Choir for the Boulanger

Soprano

Gale Silverton (BBA)
Corey Ashdown (BCCS)
Fallon Fairbanks (BCh)
Peyton Northcott (NBC)
Jamie Upton (NBC)
Bellamy Ivers (NBC)
Toby Ravenscroft (NBC)
Marley Everly (NBC)
Iris Ingram (NBC)
Skyler Abernathy (NBC)
Parker Bellweather (NBC)
Micah Kestrel (NBC)
Riley Ormsby (NBC)
Peyton Dalloway (NBC)
Sasha Wexford (NBC)
Ari Underhill (BC & BCCS)

Tenor

Corey Ashcombe (BBA)
Adair Rainford (BBA)
Jody Kingsley (BBA)
Shiloh Oakhurst (BCCS)
Finley Ellsworth (BCh)
Bellamy Whitcombe (BCh)
Shiloh Tanager (BCh)
Hollis Rainford (NBC)
Shiloh Ellsworth (NBC)
Emerson Rainford (UCD)

Alto

Skyler Davenport (BBA)
Peyton Prescott (BBA)
Riley Jessup (BBA)
Taylor Kettering (BBA)
Avery Ashcombe (BBA)
Frankie Stanhope (BCCS)
Blair Penrose (BCCS)
Remy Netherby (BCCS)
Skyler Coldwell (BCCS)
Tatum Radcliffe (BCCS)
Emerson Tanager (BCh)
Gale Birchfield (NBC)
Haven Crestwood (NBC)
Indigo Moorcroft (NBC)
Reese Hartwell (NBC)
Reese Thornbury (NBC)
Adair Whitcombe (NBC)

Bass

Tatum Brightwater (BBA)
Ari Brightwater (BBA)
Harper Edgerton (BC)
Br. Kai Lockhart (BCh)
Frankie Quimby (FCC)
Noel Marwood (NBC)
Leslie Ashcombe (NBC)
Peyton Vandermeer (NBC)
Shiloh Quimby (NBC)
Jamie Glenhaven (NBC)
Ari Upton (NBC)

Battenkill Chorale (BCh)
Bennington County Choral Society (BCCS)
Burr and Burton Academy (BBA)
Northern Berkshire Chorale (NBC)
Bennington College Voice Studios (BC)
First Congregational Church of Manchester (FCC)
Choir of the United Church of Dorset and East Rupert (UCD)

Volunteer!

We invite you to join us in bringing music to our community! Whether you are a musician/player, an avid listener, or general supporter of the arts, there are opportunities to help the organization. We can use more people to fulfill other tasks, such as hanging posters, sending out press releases,

posting on social media, setting up chairs, organizing fundraisers, helping with finances, and more. Please speak to a Board member, email us at sagecity802@gmail.com, or contact us through our website (www.sagecitysymphony.org).

Special Mention

The Matching Fund drive by Karl Brosch brought in a wave of donations last year. In concert with extraordinarily generous donations by these other donors, we have created a reserve fund to give us greater flexibility in handling future fiscal challenges. We are especially thankful to Karl Brosch, Nan Newton, Christine Graham, Julius Rosenwald and Margo Gardner, Charles and Linda Putney, Joan Devoe and Lyndon Moors, Dennis and Marcy McCarthy, and Lee and Melinda Paquin.

We thank the estate of Laura Nowak for giving Sage City Symphony a Legacy gift, and those who donated honor of Jessica Howard, teacher